



Yahoo! Widgets or Konfabulator, all your fun things at one place

cases the 500 most interesting photos from Flickr each day. And for nature lovers, the National Geographic Picture of the Day widget (<http://widgets.yahoo.com/widgets/national-geographic-picture-of-the-day>) promises to satiate your thirst for great scenic photographs every day.

Weather

If you wish to know the weather outside while sitting in your comfortable, insulated office cubicle, the default Yahoo! Weather widget is by far the best of the lot available. Its simplicity is what makes it so useful.

Click on it once in the Yahoo! Widgets dock to start it up, and you will see the weather settings for Sunnyvale – the international headquarters for Yahoo!. Click on it for a drop-down bar to change your location. In the ensuing box, just type the name of the city you're looking for, such as Mumbai or New Delhi, in the first blank bar. Yahoo! Weather recognises most international cities and will update your information accordingly.

The Weather widget itself is quite useful as in its mini mode, it will show you the current temperature outside and whether it's cloudy or sunny with an image representing the same. A drop-down icon in the bottom-left corner will give expanded information such as weather forecast for the next four days based on readings from Weather.com, as well as details of the current climatic conditions such as humidity, pressure, sunrise and sunset.

While Yahoo! uses Fahrenheit by default, Indian users might prefer to have their temperature readings in degrees Celsius. To change this, right-click anywhere on the widget, choose 'Widget Preferences' and check the box for 'Use metric units'.

Clock

The default analogue and digital clocks provide all the functionality you could want from a clock. They are both skinnable as well, with extra skins available at their respective pages in the Yahoo! Widgets gallery.

If you are looking for a great timer countdown widget, the best one we have come across is the Atomic Timer (<http://widgets.yahoo.com/widgets/atomic-timer>). Feature-rich, incredibly customisable and yet easy to use and configure, you will not need to even look at any other timer.

RSS reader

Without a doubt, the biggest flaw in Yahoo! Widgets is the lack of a good RSS reader. We tried out eight different RSS readers and tickers, but not one of them managed to impress us. The best option for those who absolutely want one is the RSS Reader widget (<http://widgets.yahoo.com/widgets/rss-reader>). It will let you add, remove and manage several feeds, as well as customise your font and the look of the widget. However, for some inexplicable reason, it does not support Word Wrap and keeps making you resize the window to read headlines that are larger than the width of the window. If you have a large screen and plan to keep this elongated all the time, it's

a worthy choice. Otherwise, we would strongly suggest sticking to a standalone RSS reader or ticker.

Webcomics reader

Just like with RSS readers, reading comics through a widget faces a similar issue of lack of contenders, when it comes to an all-in-one solution. The only decent option is DailyDose (<http://widgets.yahoo.com/widgets/daily-dose>), but it lets you monitor only three comics at a time. To add the comic strip of your choice, you will have to go to the Widget Preferences and copy-paste the web link to your desired comic. There are ample customisation options available for the comics through the widget preferences for the same, which are explained through an example comic already loaded.

However, if you must have your fix of daily comics through Yahoo! Widgets, most of the popular comics already have great individual widgets ready, including the likes of Calvin and Hobbes, Penny Arcade, Dilbert, Garfield, Ctrl+Alt+Del and XKCD. Just search for your favourite comic in the Yahoo! Widgets gallery and you should find it easily.

Mozilla Thunderbird 3

After spending 15 minutes with Thunderbird 3 (TB3), our first reaction was one of delight: Mozilla is back! Just like Gmail made Thunderbird 2 seem silly and archaic, TB3 makes Gmail seem utterly limited. The biggest reason for this is that at the end of the day, Gmail is an online email client; Mozilla has made Thunderbird 3 into what can best be described as a 'communication management' tool.